



V-2 rockets could reach 3,400 mph (547 km/h).

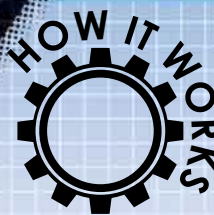


Soviet rockets

The **SOVIET UNION** (modern-day Russia and other Eastern European countries) blasted the first satellite into space in 1957 using the Sputnik rocket, designed by **Sergey Korolev**. Korolev also developed the Vostok rocket, which shot the first human being, **Yuri Gagarin** (left), into orbit in 1961.

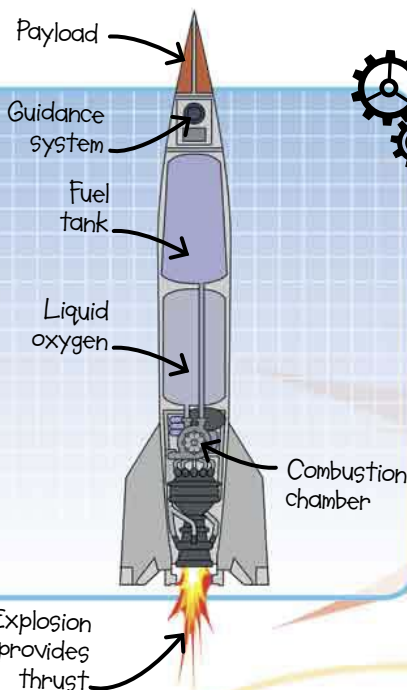
Man on the Moon

Soon after, in the United States, von Braun designed the **Saturn V** rocket (right) that took the first people to the Moon during the Apollo 11 mission. The rocket was 363 ft (111 m) tall, but only the **command module** (the cabin for the astronauts) was designed to return to Earth. Most of the rocket consisted of tanks that housed the fuel needed to **escape Earth's gravity**.



HOW IT WORKS

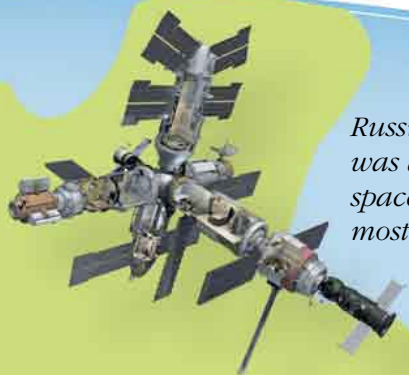
All rockets burn fuel, either solid or liquid, to provide thrust. V-2 rockets used liquid fuel and liquid oxygen. These are stored in big fuel tanks. They are mixed together in the combustion chamber and burned to become hot gas. The gas is then pushed out the back of the engine to drive the rocket forward.



How it changed

Rockets have transported people outside Earth's atmosphere for the first time, leading us to discover more about the Universe and our place in it.

the world



Russia's **Mir** space station was assembled in stages in space. It was manned for most of its **15-YEAR** life.



AMERICA's reusable space shuttle was launched exactly 20 years after **YURI GAGARIN** became the first person in space.